



CHATTERBOTS

Chat Bots, one of the earliest forms of AI, test the ability of an intelligent agent to converse with a human in natural language

When you talk about artificial intelligence systems, conversational abilities are one of the pre-requisites that anyone looks for. Blame it on the science fiction we've grown up on, but be it HAL 9000 or The Terminator, we expect intelligent agents to talk to us, not just perform their operations coldly.

The Turing Test makes this a necessity in the judgement of artificial intelligence. The test involves the ability of the machine to fool a human into thinking it's human through a series of textual conversations. Naturally, when this test became the de facto standard in trying to assess an AI system, a lot of computer scientists started working on programs specifically built to pass the test.

These talking agents ended up earning the scientific title of "Artificial Conversational Entities", but were more often referred to as chatterbots or chat bots.